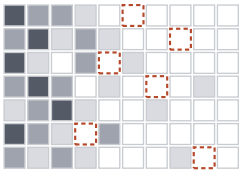
Today



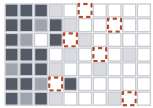
phenomena →

mechanisms from any field →

Work piles up in a few cells of each row. Empty cells are the tail, and a few of them are useful.

Range of mechanisms in use

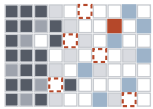
100%



Relying on AI

Researchers build on the AI's top picks, and the same cells fill.

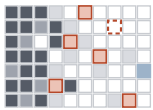
narrows to 41% of today



Generation alone

Researchers try untried ideas at random, mostly duds, and convention still piles up.

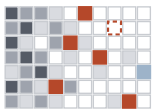
narrows to 54% of today



Selected, too little absorption

Researchers select useful tail ideas, but others write only about 10 follow-ups on each.

narrows to 70% of today



Selected and absorbed

Researchers select useful tail ideas, and others write about 40 follow-ups on each.

widens to 144% of today

Existing work

- Much work (convention)
- Some work
- Empty (the tail)

Tail ideas

- Useful, not yet pursued
- Useful, selected but not absorbed
- Useful, absorbed (others build on it)
- Dud (pursued, but not useful)